CAREER

Non-Tech to Data Analyst in 90 Days. The Exact Plan

A week-by-week 90-day plan for people from non-tech backgrounds: what to learn, what to build each week, and how to get interviews at the end.

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Before you start

Your non-tech background is an advantage if you use it.

Use your domain

Sales, HR, finance, operations, teaching: pick datasets from that world. You understand the business questions better than most freshers.

Time needed

1.5 to 2 hours on weekdays, 4 hours on weekends.

Tools (all free)

Excel or Google Sheets, PostgreSQL, Power BI Desktop, Python with Jupyter.

One rule

Every week ends with something you built, not something you watched.

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Weeks 1 to 3: Excel

Most analyst jobs still start and end in Excel.

- **Week 1**

  Formulas: SUMIFS, COUNTIFS, IF, XLOOKUP, TEXT and date functions. Build: a cleaned sales sheet.

- **Week 2**

  Pivot tables, charts, conditional formatting. Build: a monthly sales summary.

- **Week 3**

  Power Query basics and a one-page dashboard. Build: an interactive Excel dashboard with slicers.

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Weeks 4 to 7: SQL

The single most tested skill in data analyst interviews.

- **Week 4**

  SELECT, WHERE, ORDER BY, GROUP BY, HAVING.

- **Week 5**

  Joins: INNER, LEFT, finding missing records.

- **Week 6**

  CASE WHEN, date functions, subqueries and CTEs.

- **Week 7**

  Window functions: ROW_NUMBER, RANK, LAG, running totals. Build: answer 10 business questions on one dataset.

Target by week 7: 50 practice questions solved, written by you, not copied.

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Weeks 8 to 10: Power BI

Turns your SQL and Excel skills into something managers can see.

- **Week 8**

  Load data, Power Query cleaning, star schema, Date table.

- **Week 9**

  DAX: SUM, DIVIDE, CALCULATE, time intelligence (YTD, last year, YoY %).

- **Week 10**

  Report design and publishing. Build: an end-to-end dashboard on a dataset from your own domain.

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Weeks 11 and 12: Python and statistics

Enough to clean data and answer "is this difference real?".

- **Week 11**

  Python basics and Pandas: load, clean, groupby, merge, one chart.

- **Week 12**

  Statistics: mean vs median, distributions, correlation, A/B test basics. Build: a Python notebook analysing one dataset with written insights.

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Week 13: Get interviews

The skills are done. Now make them visible.

Portfolio

3 projects on GitHub (Excel, SQL + Power BI, Python), each with a 1-page README: question, approach, findings.

Resume

Lead with projects. Add your past domain experience as a strength: "5 years in retail operations".

LinkedIn

Headline: "Data Analyst | SQL, Power BI, Excel | Retail domain". Post one project breakdown.

Applications

20 targeted applications through referrals, focusing on companies in your old domain.

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How to talk about the switch

Every interviewer will ask why you moved. Have this ready.

- **The story**

  "In my last role I kept making decisions from incomplete reports. I learned data analysis to fix that, and built 3 projects using real data from my domain."

- **Lead with domain**

  "I understand how a sales team actually uses these numbers" is something freshers cannot say.

- **Show the projects**

  Open your best dashboard on screen and walk through one insight.

Honest note: 90 days makes you job-ready for entry-level roles. Most people take 1 to 3 more months of applying to land the first offer. Keep practising while you apply.

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